HIST 201: United States to 1865
Fall 2026
Monday: 2:00-3:15pm JSC 333 (in person)
Wednesday: 2:00-3:15pm (online recorded lecture)

Faculty Information
Dr. Sandra Slater
Maybank 313
Email: slaters@cofc.edu (I will respond usually within 24 hours)
Office Hours: Mondays, 1:00-2:00pm (in person). Zoom appointments for outside office hours are available; send me an email to coordinate.

Course Description and Goals
This course is designed to provide an overview of American history from the pre-contact period through Reconstruction. Topics include indigenous cultures, contact, colonial patterns and settlement, the American Revolution, the early republic, the antebellum period, the American Civil War, and Reconstruction. This will be an intersectional class, meaning that we will address historical processes of political, economic, and religious history, in addition to discussing issues of race, class, and gender. In this class we will work closely with primary source materials.

Required Texts:
- Eric Foner, et. al., *Give Me Liberty!* 7th edition, Brief, Vol. 1 (W. W. Norton)
- Kendall Hunt Reader Online (KH)

Humanities General Education Student Learning Outcome: Global and/or Cultural Perspective
- Students identifies or frames a perspective or expression of human culture.
- Students analyze how the perspective or expression is represented, interpreted, or valued.
- Student describes the significance of the perspective or expression of human culture.

This outcome will be assessed the second primary source essay.

The following documents will be read in their entirety in compliance with the REACH Act (Available in Kendall Hunt Online Reader):

- Declaration of Independence
- United States Constitution
- Emancipation Proclamation
- Federalist Papers 2, 12, 38, 45, 54
- David Walker, "Preamble to *Walker's Appeal in Four Articles* (1830)"

Readings and Class Participation
Students must complete readings in a timely fashion to make possible full participation in class discussions and exercises. Make sure that you analyze all readings carefully and critically by the beginning of the class period for which they are assigned. Come to class with notes on the readings and be prepared to both answer questions and ask questions about the readings. Participation grades will be calculated based on both the frequency of your contributions in class and on the quality of your comments. In particular, I am looking for evidence that you have completed the readings and that you are connecting them to the themes we have discussed in class.

Attendance
You are allowed 1 total excused/unexcused absences. I don't need documentation.

Class Rules

- Racism, sexism, agism, or any denigrating speech toward another person or groups will NOT be tolerated. You will receive an initial warning, but if the behavior persists you will be asked to leave the class and will be counted absent as a result.
- I have an open-door policy and encourage you all to visit me in my office to discuss your papers or any problems that may arise over the course of the semester.
- You must be prepared having done the course readings before class. I reserve the right to dismiss you from class for lack of preparation.
- Please refrain from using your phones during class.

Grading
10% Primary Source Assignment One
20% Primary Source Assignment Two (General Education Humanities Assessment)
60% Online quizzes
10% Participation

Grading Scale

94-100%= A	74-76%= C
90-93%= A-	70-73%=C-
87-89%= B+	67-69%= D+
84-86%= B	64-66%= D
80-83%= B-	60-63%= D-
77-79%=C+	<60%= F

Assignments

Over the course of the semester, we will read and discuss several primary sources to provide additional insight into the topics covered in the course. You will write three primary source analysis papers in which you provide historical context, a critical reading of the text, and assess its contribution to understanding a particular historical moment. These are formal writing assignments. The third primary source analysis will serve as your General Education Assessment submission.

10% Primary Source Assignment One
20% Primary Source Assessment Two
(Humanities General Education Assessment Piece)

There will be four exams over the course of the semester. You are expected to use class lectures and textbook and primary source readings to fully answer each quiz. These are a mixture of multiple choice, true/false, and essays.

15% Exam One
15% Exam Two
15% Exam Three
15% Exam Four

Participation is a crucial component of this class. You are expected to complete your course readings BEFORE class and actively participate in class discussions. All listed OAKS readings will be discussed in class. Any indication that students are not reading the assignments may result in pop quizzes to assess engagement. **To earn the full participation grade, you must also attend TWO lectures/events held on campus that intersect with course content. Appropriate events will be advertised throughout the class.**

10% Participation

Students must complete readings in a timely fashion to make possible full participation in class discussions and exercises. Make sure that you analyze all readings carefully and critically *by the beginning of the class period for which they are assigned.* Come to class with notes on the readings and be prepared to both answer and ask questions about the readings. Participation grades will be calculated based on both the frequency of your contributions in class and, more importantly, the *quality* of your comments. I am looking for evidence that you have completed the readings and that you are connecting them to the themes we have discussed in class. When I calculate final attendance and participation grades, I use the following general guidelines:

A = student has attended almost every class, participates regularly, demonstrates knowledge of readings, makes thoughtful and insightful comments, and asks relevant questions.

B = student has attended almost every class and participates regularly. Comments and questions are relevant but could be more thoughtful; student could engage more deeply with the readings or course materials.
C = student has attended almost every class but does not participate regularly.
D = student demonstrates spotty attendance and rarely participates.
F = student has attendance problems and does not contribute to class discussions in any meaningful way.

Honor Code and Academic Integrity: Lying, cheating, attempted cheating, and plagiarism are violations of our Honor Code that, when identified, are investigated. Each incident will be examined to determine the degree of deception involved. Incidents where the instructor determines the student's actions are related more to a misunderstanding will handled by the instructor. A written intervention designed to help prevent the student from repeating the error will be given to the student. The intervention, submitted by form and signed both by the instructor and the student, will be forwarded to the Dean of Students and placed in the student's file. Cases of suspected academic dishonesty will be reported directly by the instructor and/or others having knowledge of the incident to the Dean of Students. A student found responsible by the Honor Board for academic dishonesty will receive a XF in the course, indicating failure of the course due to academic dishonesty. This grade will appear on the student's transcript for two years after which the student may petition for the X to be expunged. The student may also be placed on disciplinary probation, suspended (temporary removal) or expelled (permanent removal) from the College by the Honor Board. Students should be aware that unauthorized collaboration--working together without permission-- is a form of cheating. Unless the instructor specifies that students can work together on an assignment, quiz and/or test, no collaboration during the completion of the assignment is permitted. Other forms of cheating include possessing or using an unauthorized study aid (which could include accessing information via a cell phone or computer), copying from others' exams, fabricating data, and giving unauthorized assistance. Research conducted and/or papers written for other classes cannot be used in whole or in part for any assignment in this class without obtaining prior permission from the instructor. Students can find the complete Honor Code and all related processes in the Student Handbook at
http://studentaffairs.cofc.edu/honorsystem/studenthandbook/index.php

No Permissible Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GAI)
Generative Artificial Intelligence (GAI) tools are not permitted for any work in this class. If you use GAI tools, your actions would be considered academically dishonest and a violation of the College of Charleston's Honor Code and Code of Conduct. Students are bound by honor and by their enrollment at the College to abide by the specific policies of the Honor Code and the Code of Conduct, and to report any violations of the Honor System. All work submitted in this course must be your own, completed in accordance with the College's Honor Code. You may not engage in unauthorized collaboration or make use of ChatGPT or other GAI tools.

Since writing, analytical, and critical thinking skills are part of the learning outcomes of this course, all writing assignments should be prepared solely by the student and without any

assistance. Questions in this regard should be shared directly with your professor. Developing strong competencies in this area will prepare you for a competitive workplace. Therefore, support of any generative artificial intelligence (GAI) tools is not permitted, and submissions using GAI will be treated as plagiarism per the College of Charleston's Honor Code.

Automated Writing Tools
Unless otherwise specified, the use of generative artificial intelligence (GAI), including ChatGPT and similar tools, is strictly prohibited in this course, even when appropriately referenced. The use of automated writing tools will be considered plagiarism and a violation of the CofC Honor Code.

Writing Lab
I encourage you to take advantage of the Writing Lab in the Center for Student Learning (Addlestone Library, first floor). Trained writing consultants can help with writing for all courses; they offer one-to-one consultations that address everything from brainstorming and developing ideas to crafting strong sentences and documenting sources**. No appointment necessary. Just walk in!** Convenient hours: Mon-Thurs 11-8 and Sundays 4 to 8 p.m., and **Fridays 11-2**.

For more information, please call 843.953.5635 or for useful handouts visit https://cofc.sharepoint.com/sites/hub-csl/SitePages/Study-Skills.aspx

Student Resources

- Campus Continuity and Transition to Online Learning: https://continuity.cofc.edu/index.php
- Technology Help Desk: https://it.cofc.edu/help/studentcomputing.php
- Student Instruction Technology Services (Library): https://blogs.cofc.edu/sits/
- Borrowing Technology and Equipment (Library): http://libguides.library.cofc.edu/undergraduatestudentservices

Statement on Access/Disability
The College will make reasonable accommodations for persons with documented disabilities. Students should apply for services at the Center for Disability Services/SNAP located on the first floor of the Lightsey Center, Suite 104. Students approved for accommodations are responsible for notifying me as soon as possible and for contacting me one week before accommodation is needed.

Statement on "Religious Accommodation for Students"
The College of Charleston community is enriched by students of many faiths that have various religious observances, practices, and beliefs. We value student rights and freedoms, including the right of each student to adhere to individual systems of religion. The College prohibits

discrimination against any student because of such student's religious belief or any absence thereof. The College acknowledges that religious practices differ from tradition to tradition and that the demands of religious observances in some traditions may cause conflicts with student schedules. In affirming this diversity, like many other colleges and universities, the College supports the concept of "reasonable accommodation for religious observance" in regard to class attendance, and the scheduling of examinations and other academic work requirements, unless the accommodation would create an undue hardship on the College. Faculty are required, as part of their responsibility to students and the College, to ascribe to this policy and to ensure its fair and full implementation. The accommodation request imposes responsibilities and obligations on both the individual requesting the accommodation and the College. Faculty members are expected to reasonably accommodate individual religious practices. Examples of reasonable accommodations for student absences might include: rescheduling of an exam or giving a make-up exam for the student in question; altering the time of a student's presentation; allowing extra-credit assignments to substitute for missed class work or arranging for an increased flexibility in assignment dates. Regardless of any accommodation that may be granted, students are responsible for satisfying all academic objectives, requirements and prerequisites as defined by the instructor and by the College.

Mental & Physical Wellbeing:
At the college, we take every students' mental and physical wellbeing seriously. If you find yourself experiencing physical illnesses, please reach out to student health services (843.953.5520). And if you find yourself experiencing any mental health challenges (for example, anxiety, depression, stressful life events, sleep deprivation, and/or loneliness/homesickness) please consider contacting either the Counseling Center (professional counselors at http://counseling.cofc.edu or 843.953.5640 3rd Robert Scott Small Building) or the Students 4 Support (certified volunteers through texting "4support" to 839863, visit http://counseling.cofc.edu/cct/index.php, or meet with them in person 3rd Floor Stern Center). These services are there for you to help you cope with difficulties you may be experiencing and to maintain optimal physical and mental health.

Safe Environment
CofC is committed to providing an environment free of all forms of prohibited discrimination, including sexual harassment and violence (i.e. sexual assault, domestic and dating violence, and gender or sex-based bullying and stalking). If you have experienced discrimination or harassment, help and support are available. CofC employees, other
than designated confidential resources, must report information they receive about prohibited discrimination, including sexual harassment and sexual violence. This means that if you tell me about a situation involving sexual harassment, sexual violence, discrimination, or harassment, I must share the information with the Title IX Coordinator. You may speak to someone confidentially by contacting the Office of Victim Services at 843-953-2273, Counseling Center at 843-953-5640, or Student Health Services at 843-953-5520. You can also report any sexual

misconduct or discrimination, or learn more about your options and resources, by contacting the Office of Equal Opportunity Programs at 843-953-5754.

Financial Challenges: If a student has difficulty affording groceries or getting sufficient food to eat every day, or who lacks a safe and stable place to live, and believes this may affect their performance in the course, please contact the Dean of Students for support. Furthermore, please notify Professor ABC if you are comfortable in doing so. This will enable him to assist with identifying available resources.

Weather: If the College of Charleston closes and members of the community are evacuated due to inclement weather, students are responsible for taking course materials with them to continue with course assignments consistent with instructions provided by faculty. In cases of extended periods of institution-wide closure where students have relocated, instructors may articulate a plan that allows for supplemental academic engagement despite these circumstances.

Land and Labor Acknowledgement

We are located on the traditional lands of the first people of Charleston: the Etiwan, Kiawah, Edisto Natchez Kusso, Santee, and Wassamasaw people (also known as Varner Town Indians). We acknowledge and honor all indigenous people who lived, labored and were faithful stewards of the land. We express our deep gratitude for the land and continued faithful stewardship to the next generations.

We also acknowledge the lives and labor of the Africans who were enslaved to build Charleston, South Carolina. On this campus and in this space, African and African-descended people used skilled labor in ornamental ironwork, historic architecture, and low country agriculture and food production. As a member of the College of Charleston community, I acknowledge the Black lives and labor that built our city and our campus.

Course Outline

Red: days we meet in person
Foner: textbook, *Give Me Liberty!*
KH: Kendall Hunt Online Reader
Green are assignments (all due by 11:59pm)
Yellow is online recorded lectures

M 08/17 Course Introduction

W 08/19 Idea of the New Word/European Conquest
Kaltura: Idea of the New World, New France, New Spain
Readings:
Foner, Chapter 1, pgs.1-39

M 08/24 Contact Period/Discussion of Sources
Readings:
KH: Bartolome de las Casas

W 08/26 British Colonization in North America
Kaltura: Early English Colonization and Early New England
Readings:
Foner, Chapter 2, pgs. 56-78

M 08/31 English Colonization Discussion
Readings:
KH: Plymouth Colony Court Records

W 09/02 Atlantic Economies
Kaltura: Atlantic Economies and Labor
Readings:
Foner, Chapter 3, pgs. 78-95

M 09/07 Labor in Early America
Readings:
Foner, 110-130
Foner, pg. 90-91 "Maryland Act Concerning Negroes and Other Slaves (1664)" and "Letter by an Indentured Servant" (in the textbook)

W 09/09 French and Indian War
French and Indian War Documentary (TBA)
Readings:
Foner, 130-145

Su 09/13 Exam One – Colonial America – Due at 11:59pm (OAKS under Quizzes)

M 09/14 American Revolution Documentary (TBA)
Readings:
Foner, Chapter 5, pgs. 146-154

W 09/16 American Revolution
Kaltura: American Revolution (first half)
Readings:
Foner, Chapter 5, 154-172

M 09/21 American Revolution Discussion
Readings:
KH: Thomas Paine
KH: Declaration of Independence

W 09/23 American Revolution Continued (second half)
Kaltura: American Revolution

F 09/25 Primary Source Assignment Due to Dropbox by 11:59pm

M 09/28 The Limits of Liberty (Marginalized voices in the American Revolution)
Readings:
Foner, Chapter 6, pgs. 187-201
KH: OAKS: Prince Hall, "Petition for Freedom to the Massachusetts Council and the House of Representatives (1777)
KH: Judith Sargent Murray, "On the Equality of the Sexes (1790)"

W 09/30 Early Republic
Kaltura: The New Nation and Politics of the Early Republic
Readings:
Foner, Chapter 7, pgs. 201-246
KH: United States Constitution (Bill of Rights)
KH: Federalist Papers 2, 12, 38, 45, 54

M 10/05 Early Republic Conversation and Bill of Rights Debate

W 10/07 War of 1812

War of 1812 Documentary TBA

Readings:

Foner, Chapter 8, 246-254

KH: Tecumseh, "Sleep Not Longer, O Choctaws and Chickasaws (1811)"

F 10/09 Exam Two—American Revolution and Early Republic—Due at 11:59pm (OAKS under Quizzes)

M 10/12 Fall Break- No Class

W 10/14 Triumph of Democracy

Kaltura: Triumph of Democracy

M 10/19 Market Revolution

Kaltura: Market Revolution/Industrial Revolution

Readings:

Foner, Chapter 9, pgs. 254-272

W 10/21 Social Consequences of the Market and Industrial Revolution

Kaltura: Social Consequences of the Industrial Revolution

Readings:

KH: William Sanger and Prostitution

M 10/26 Jacksonian Politics

Documentary: Andrew Jackson: Good and Evil and the Presidency

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EGfxyeuy8u8

Readings:

KH: Cherokee Women, "Petition (1831)"

W 10/28 Social Reform Movements

Kaltura: Social Reform Movements

Readings:

Foner, Chapter 12, pgs. 340-366

M 11/02 Reform Movement Discussion

KH: Sarah Grimke, "Letters on the Equality of the Sexes and the Condition of Woman (1837)"

KH: David Walker, "Preamble to *Walker's Appeal in Four Articles* (1830)"

W 11/04 The Peculiar Institution

Kaltura: The Peculiar Institution

Readings:

Foner, Chapter 11, 314-340

F 11/06 Exam Three—Market Revolution and Social Change in the early 19th Century—Due at 11:59pm (OAKS under Quizzes)

M 11/09 Manifest Destiny and Westward Expansion

Readings:

Foner, Chapter 13, pgs. 383-400

W 11/11 Antebellum Politics and Society

Kaltura: Peculiar Institution and the Coming of the Civil War

Readings:

Foner, Chapter 13, pgs. 383-400

M 11/16 American Civil War

Kaltura: American Civil War Part 1

Readings:

Foner, Chapter 14, 400-430

W 11/18 American Civil War Continued

Kaltura: American Civil War Part 2

Readings:

Foner, Chapter 14, 430-474

Su 11/22 Exam Four—The National Civil War---Due at 11:59pm (OAKS under Quizzes)

M 11/23 American Civil War and Reconstruction Discussion

Readings:

KH: Abraham Lincoln, "Emancipation Proclamation (1863)"

KH: "Letter from Jourdon Anderson (1865)"

W 11/25 Thanksgiving

M 11/30 Writing Day

Second Primary Source Essay due to Dropbox by 11:59pm

This is your Humanities General Education Assessment Piece